Hyperborea 3e Character Creation

How to roll up character so you can play THE BEST GAME

Character Creation in Hyperborea 3e

Step 0: **Supplies** – Hyperborea 3e books or PDFs, paper and pencil, dice, optionally a character sheet from https://www.hyperborea.tv/resources.html

Step 1: **Generate Attributes –** Choose one of the six methods available in the Player's Manual

Step 2: **Choose a Class –** Select a character class that for which the generated attributes qualify

Step 3: **Develop a Background –** Choose or roll the various character background options

Step 4: **Purchase Equipment –** Roll for starting gold and purchase equipment, or utilize the starting kit for the selected class

Step 5: **Determine Starting Spells –** For sorcerous classes, randomly determine or select starting spells for the character

Step 6: **Record Other Statistics –** Based on attributes and equipment, record saving throw values, armour class, hit dice, hit points, movement, Fighting/Casting/Turning Ability

Character creation steps can be found on page 11 and 12 of the Player's Manual

Step 1 + Step 2
Generate Attributes
Choose a Class

I was a math major, so there are charts!
And my real job is management consulting, so yes, this is powerpoint.

Step 1: Generate Attributes

METHOD I: Roll 3d6 in order for each attribute: Strength (ST), Dexterity (DX), Constitution (CN), Intelligence (IN), Wisdom (WS), and Charisma (CH).

METHOD II: Roll 3d6 in order for each attribute: Strength (ST), Dexterity (DX), Constitution (CN), Intelligence (IN), Wisdom (WS), and Charisma (CH). Repeat twice, generating three total arrays. Choose one set from the three arrays as your character.

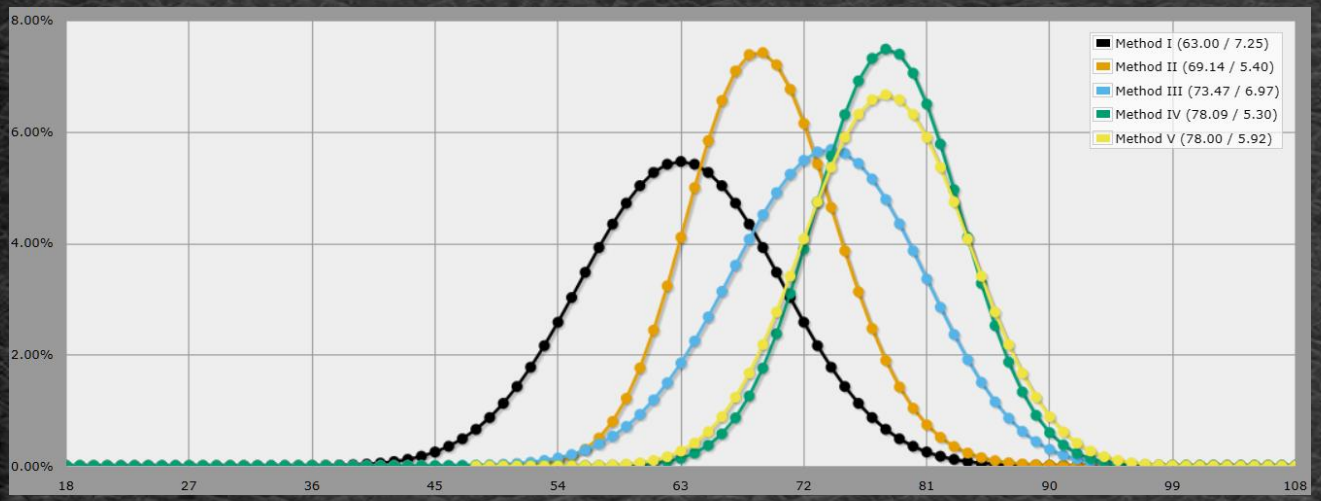
METHOD III: Roll 4d6 and ignore the lowest die roll, repeating this process six times. Assign the six scores to the attributes as desired.

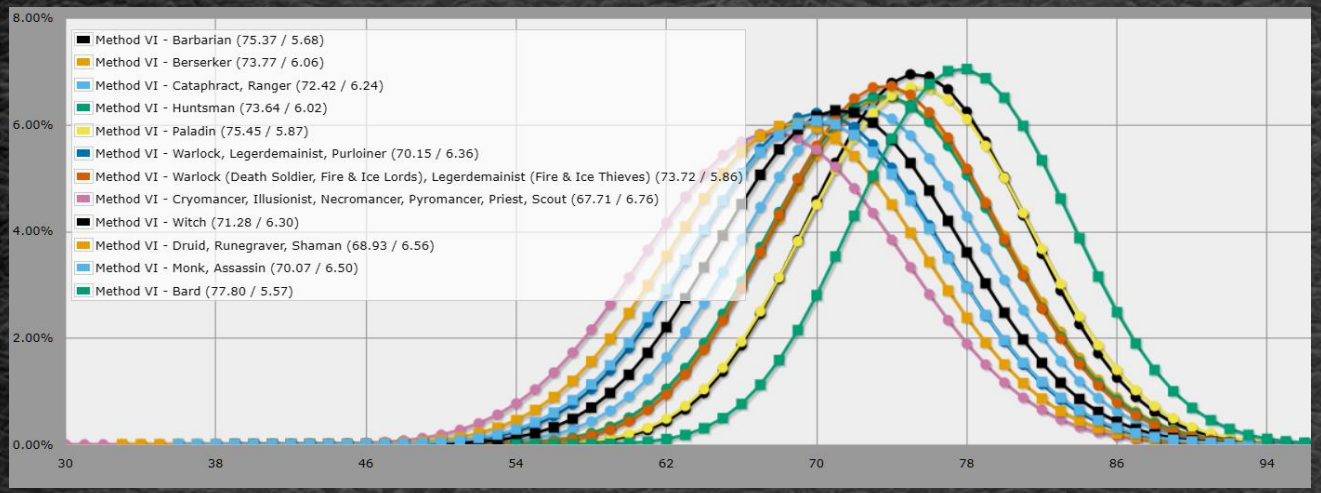
METHOD IV: Roll 3d6 three separate times for each attribute, in the order of the attributes: Strength (ST), Dexterity (DX), Constitution (CN), Intelligence (IN), Wisdom (WS), and Charisma (CH). The best result for each individual attribute is the score for that attribute.

METHOD V: Roll 2d6+6 in order for each attribute: Strength (ST), Dexterity (DX), Constitution (CN), Intelligence (IN), Wisdom (WS), and Charisma (CH).

METHOD VI: Choose a character class. For each attribute that has a minimum requirement, roll 4d6, dropping the lowest die. Repeat until the minimum score is attained. For attributes that do not have a minimum, roll 3d6.

A long time ago, in a high school far, far away...





Method I has the highest risk of low scores.
This allows the character to emerge from the oldest generation method, but will make many classes far more rare.

Methods III, IV, and V have higher averages
All three have a noticeably higher (13 vs 10.5) expected average value, as well as a tighter distribution.

Method VI allows a class selection and the stats to support it.
You'll be good enough to meet the requirements of a given class, but are unlikely to be a powerhouse. A good choice for Barbarians, Bards, and Paladins, though.

Charts generated using Anydice.com

METHOD I · The OG Method

THE ROLLS

3d6 down the line

ST 10	DX 8	CN 8
IN 7	WS 12	CH 10

QUALIFYING CLASSES

Fighter · Cleric · Priest · Runegraver

CLASS CHOICE & REASON

Priest – Ecclesiastical sorcerer; more spells than any other sorcererous class, weak in physical combat.

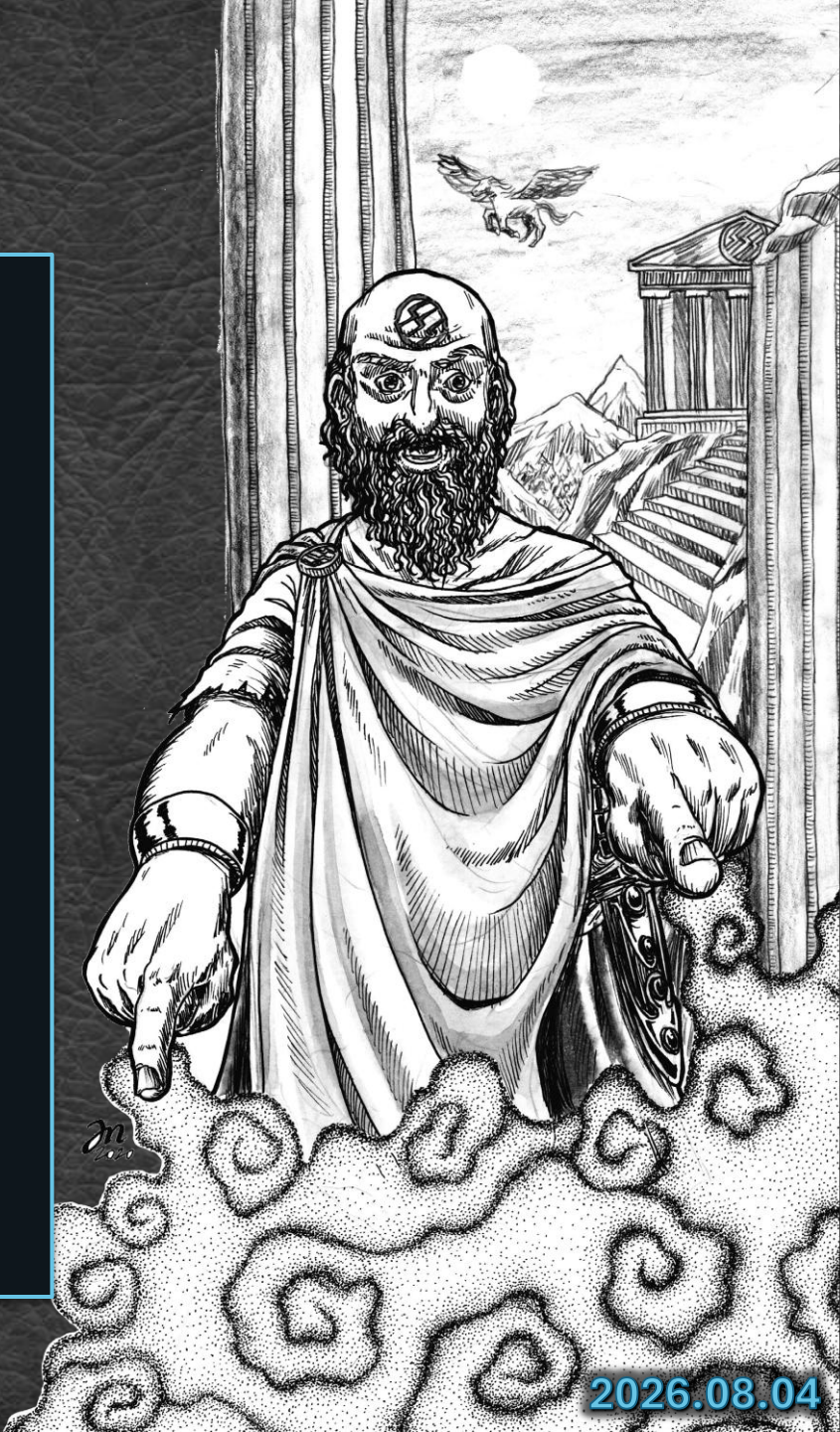
ADJUSTED ATTRIBUTES

ST 4 (−6)	DX 9 (+1)
CN 9 (+1)	IN 7
WS 13 (+1)	CH 10

WHY ADJUST?

Remove AC and hit point penalties from DX and CON.

Gain one additional 1st-level cleric spell per day from WIS.



METHOD II · The OG x3

THREE ARRAYS — PICK ONE COLUMN

ST	12	10	**16**
DX	9	13	**11**
CN	13	10	**10**
IN	13	14	**12**
WS	12	10	**12**
CH	11	11	**8**

QUALIFYING CLASSES

Fighter · Thief · Cleric · Magician · Ranger · Warlock · Cryomancer · Illusionist · Necromancer · Pyromancer · Monk · Runegraver · Shaman · Assassin · Scout

CLASS CHOICE & REASON

Runegraver – The Runegraver best benefits from high Strength and Wisdom scores. Warlock was also a consideration.

ADJUSTED ATTRIBUTES

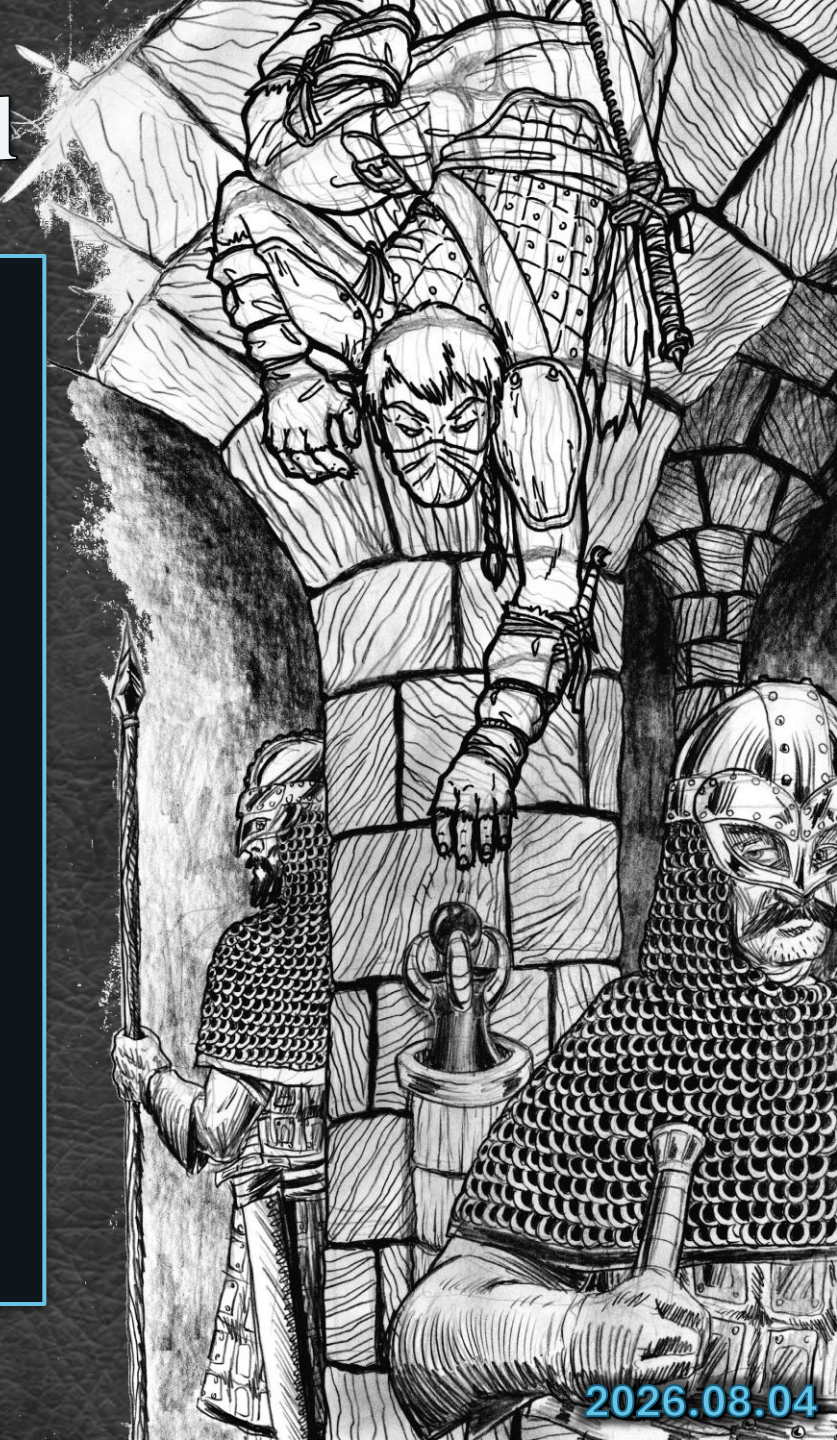
ST 16	DX 11
CN 10	IN 6 (−6)
WS 16 (+4)	CH 6 (−2)

WHY THIS ARRAY?

ST and WS at 16+ secure the +10% XP bonus.



METHOD III · The Modern Standard



THE ROLLS

4d6, drop the lowest

Assign the six results as desired.

17 - 13 - 12

12 - 13 - 13

QUALIFYING CLASSES

Every class except Berserker.

CLASS CHOICE & REASON

Legerdemainist – The illusionist school offers an interesting spell list that rewards player creativity, and the Thief abilities are useful for party play.

ADJUSTED ATTRIBUTES

ST 10 (-2)	DX 17
CN 11 (-2)	IN 17 (+4)
WS 12	CH 9 (-4)

WHY ADJUST?

DX and IN at 16+ secure the +10% XP bonus.

METHOD IV · Method II Redux

ROLL THREE TIMES; KEEP EACH BEST

ST	12	13	**14**
DX	5	**8**	7
CN	**13**	11	9
IN	13	9	**14**
WS	**14**	8	10
CH	8	**14**	6

QUALIFYING CLASSES

Fighter · Magician · Cleric · Warlock · Cryomancer · Necromancer · Pyromancer · Witch · Druid · Priest · Runegraver · Shaman

CLASS CHOICE & REASON

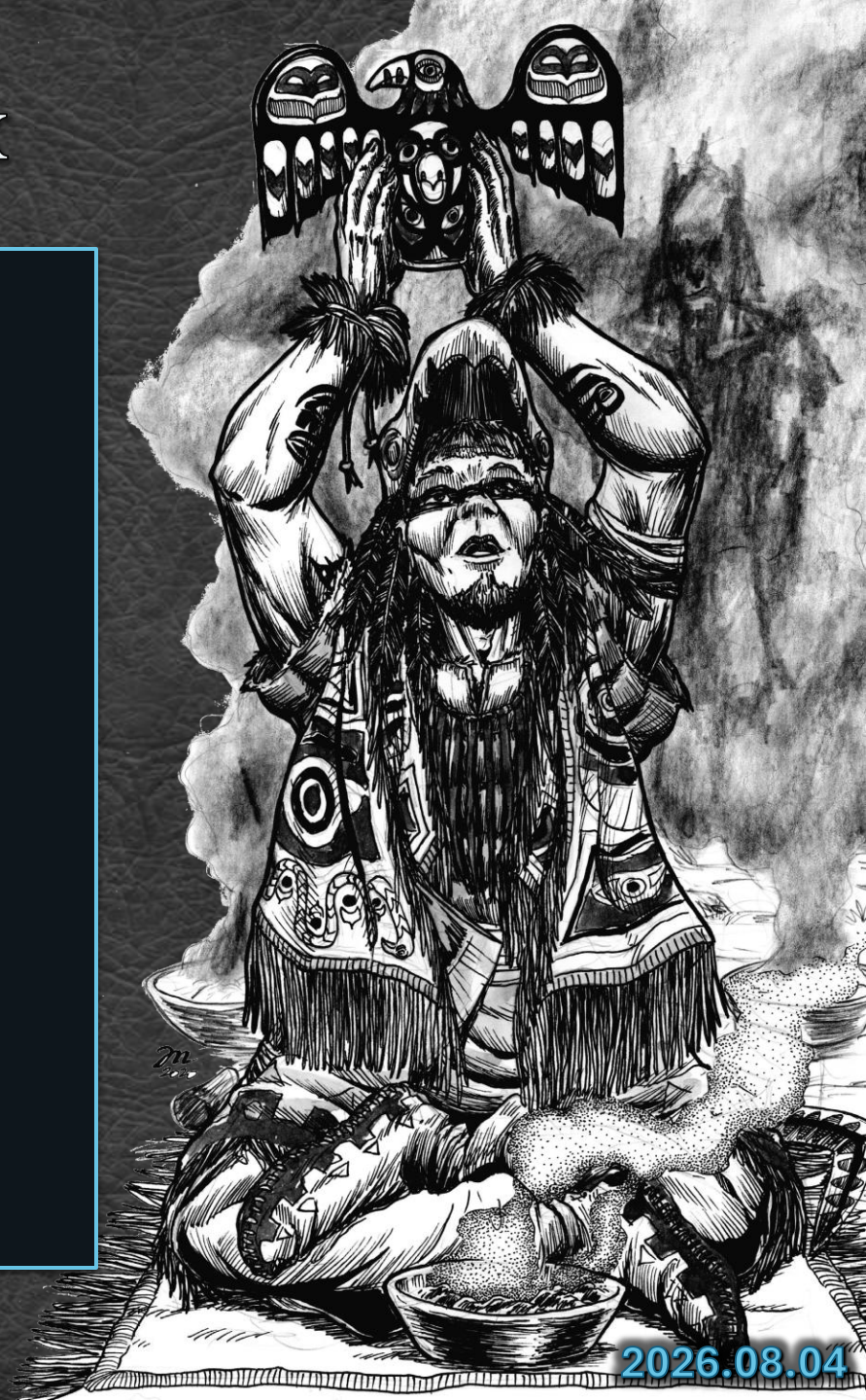
Shaman – Many classes are a solid option with this array, but Shaman offers a wide variety of sorcery options on a single character.

ADJUSTED ATTRIBUTES

ST 10 (−4)	DX 8
CN 13	IN 16 (+2)
WS 16 (+2)	CH 10 (−4)

WHY ADJUST?

IN and WS at 16+ secure the +10% XP bonus.



METHOD V · My Personal Favorite

THE ROLL

2d6 + 6 in order

ST 16	DX 10	CN 12
IN 17	WS 12	CH 14

QUALIFYING CLASSES

All except Barbarian, Berserker, Paladin, Bard, Legerdemainist, and Purloiner.

CLASS CHOICE & REASON

Warlock – Incredibly strong ST and IN stats were generated immediately, covering the requirements for 10% XP bonus immediately.

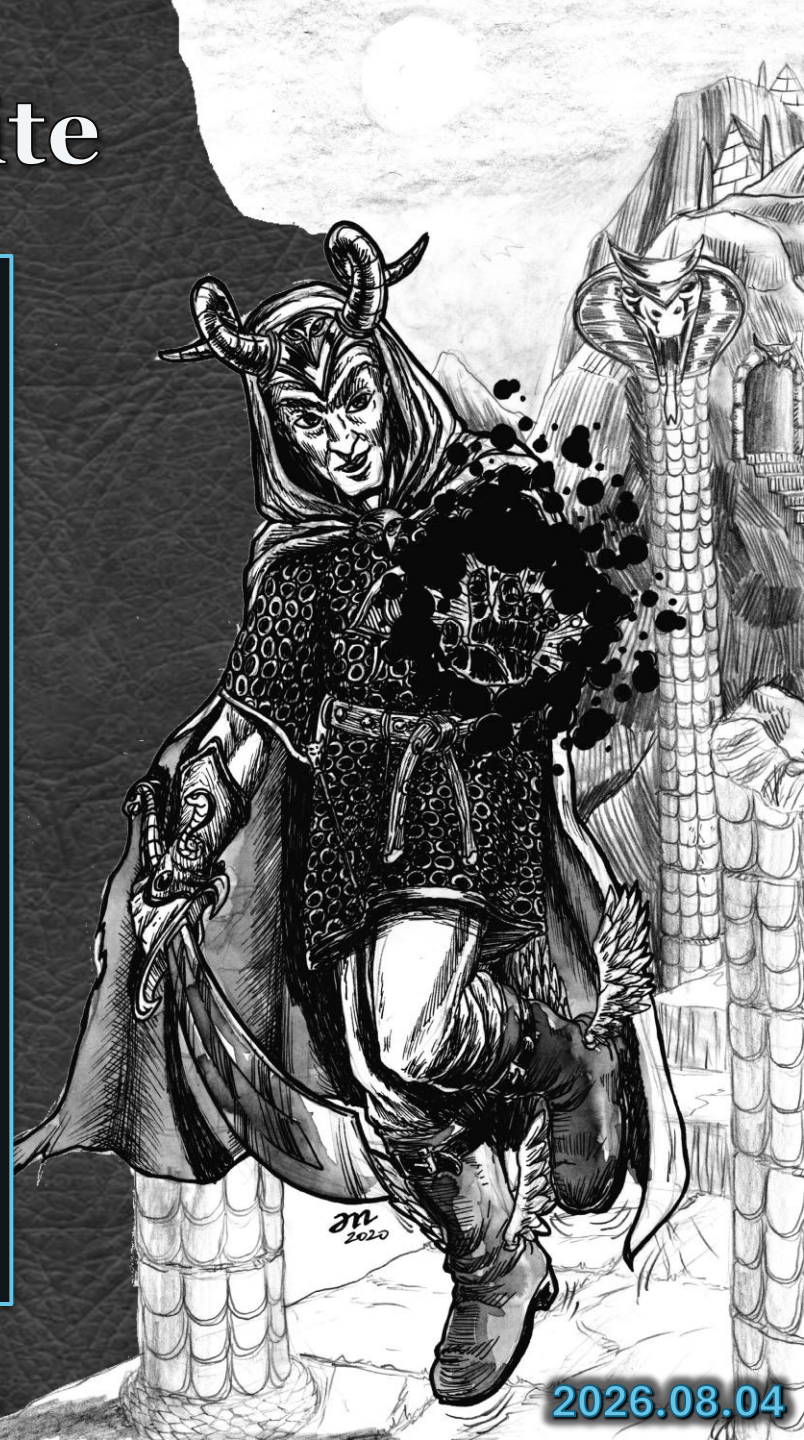
ADJUSTED ATTRIBUTES

ST 17 (+1)	DX 10
CN 15 (+3)	IN 17
WS 10 (−2)	CH 8 (−6)

WHY ADJUST?

Prime attributes become eligible for the +10% XP bonus.

Also: warlocks are awesome.



METHOD VI · Choose the class first

THE CLASS

Berserker – Requiring two attributes over 15 (ST and CN) makes it a difficult class to qualify for.

THE ROLL

Use 3d6 for attributes with no requirement.

Use 4d6, drop low—and reroll until the minimum—for required attributes.

ST 15 DX 12

CN 9 → 12 → 8 → 15

IN 5 WS 12 CH 9

ADJUSTED ATTRIBUTES

ST 16 (+1)	DX 15 (+3)
CN 16 (+1)	IN 5
WS 6 (−6)	CH 6 (−4)

WHY ADJUST?

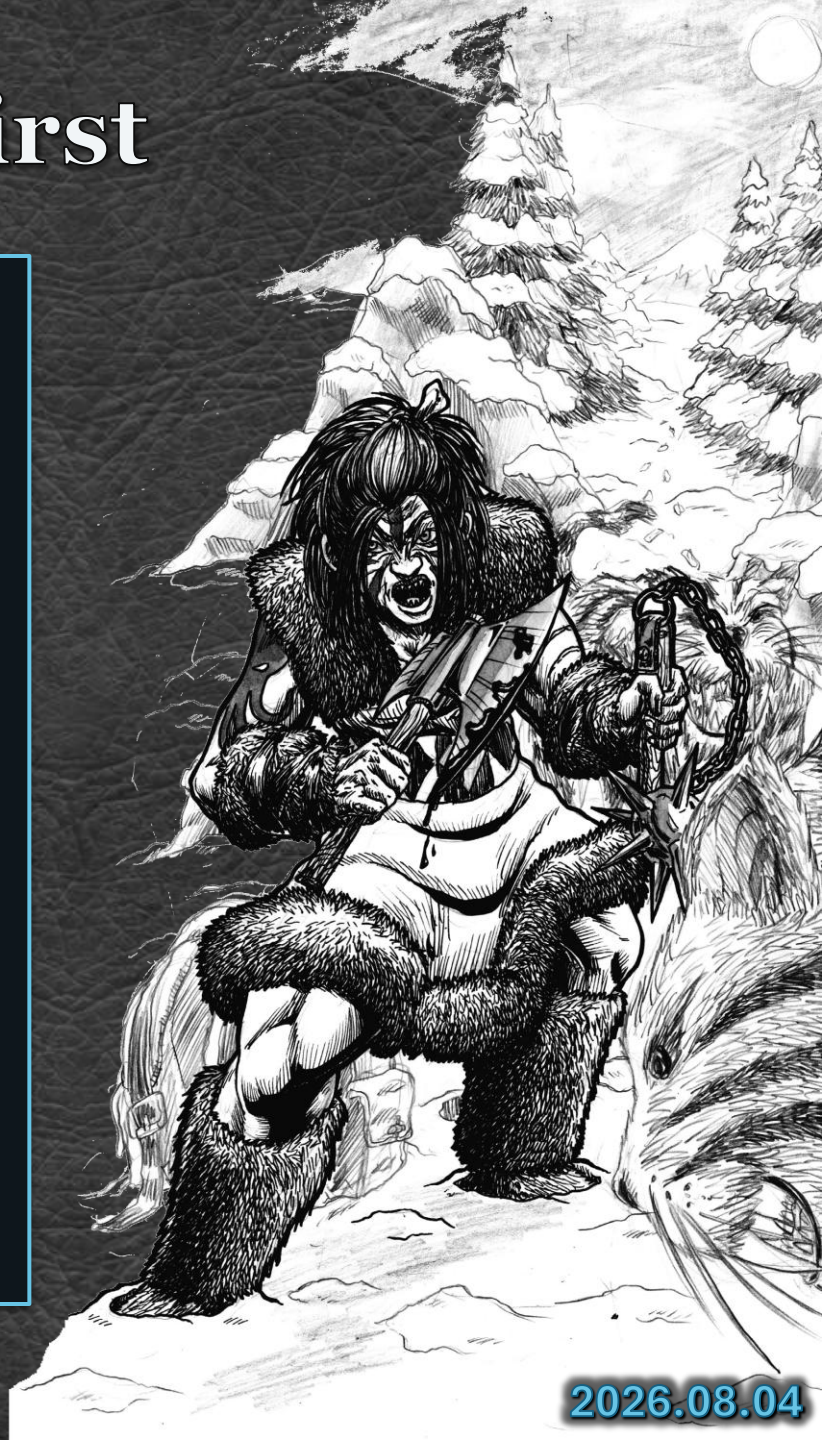
ST and CN at 16 for a +10% XP bonus.

DX 15 improves defense.

Don’t need smarts if you can smash!

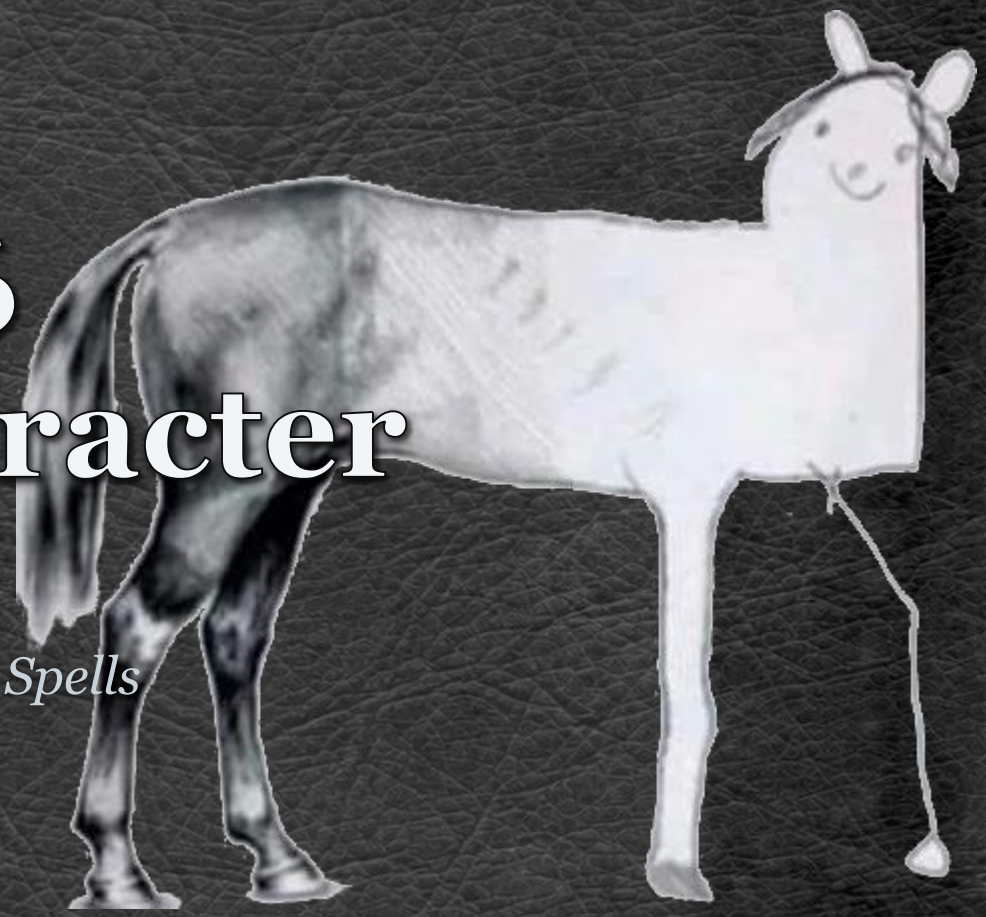
THE TRADEOFF

Your class is protected; the rest of the character can be gloriously uneven.



Steps 3-6
Finish the Character

Backgrounds, Equipment, and Spells



STEP 3 – Develop a Background – Pick or Roll!

RACE Choose a culture or roll d%; 96-00 leads to the ancillary-race table.

PHYSIQUE Choose or roll gender, age, height, weight, eyes, hair, and complexion.

ALIGNMENT Pick a world view permitted by the character class.

LANGUAGES Begin with Common and a native tongue; IN 13+ grants bonus languages.

RELIGION Select a deity, pairing, totem, ethos, or no formal faith.

SECONDARY SKILL Roll a column and row on Table 72, or select with referee approval.

Tables for these elements are found starting on page 114 of the Player's Manual.

For purposes of this exercise, I chose races and genders that matched the art in the books, rather than random determination.

STEP 4 – Class Packs vs. Purchase Equipment

OPTION A - CLASS PACK Take the ready-made list printed with the class.

OPTION B - STARTING GOLD Roll the class's starting money, then buy armour, shields, weapons, and gear.

Make note of class limitations for armour, shields, and weapons. Track carried items, ammunition, containers, money, armour class, and movement.

For this video, all six characters take their class starting pack, because I hate shopping episodes.

Each pack also supplies 1d4+1 gp; those pocket-money rolls are recorded on the character slides.

Class packs are found in each Class's section of Chapter 4. Equipment tables are found in Chapter 6: Equipment, starting on page 136 of the Player's Manual.

STEP 5 – Determine Starting Spells

1. **FIND THE SPELL LIST** The class states the schools, levels, and number of starting spells. Spell lists start on page 165 of the *Player's Manual*.
2. **ROLL d%** Match each result to the uncover range in the appropriate spell-list table. Or pick your favorites if your Referee is amenable.
3. **REROLL REPEATS** Reroll duplicate results; all known spells are distinct.
4. **RECORD BOTH TOTALS** Known spells and spells cast per day are not always the same.

KNOWN SPELLS FOR THE GENERATED CHARACTERS:

Priest: 4 cleric spells

Shaman: 1 druid spell at 1st level

Runegraver rolls its class rune table

Legerdemainist: 1 illusionist spell

Warlock: 1 magician spell.

Berserker has no spells.

Chapter 7: Sorcery begins on page 156 of the Player's Manual.

STEP 6 – Record Other Statistics

ARMOUR CLASS (AC) Start with armour, then improve it for shield and DX defence bonuses.

HIT POINTS (HP) Roll the class hit die and apply the CN adjustment; minimum 1 hp.

Many referees will house-rule maximum HP at level 1.

MOVEMENT Use the armour movement rate:

none/light 40 ft./round · medium 30 ft./round · heavy 20 feet per round.

CLASS VALUES Copy SV, FA, CA, and TA from the 1st-level class table.

SV – Saving Throw *FA – Fighting Ability* *CA – Casting Ability* *TA – Turning Ability*

CASTS PER DAY Apply eligible IN or WS bonus spells to the class spell schedule.

ZOTIKOS - PRIEST

BACKGROUND

Greek man, age 24; 5 ft. 9 in., 170 lb.

Black hair, hazel eyes; Lawful Good.

Common + Hellenic; Apollo; scribe/scrivener.

PRIEST STARTING PACK

Silver dagger, quarterstaff, whip; backpack, bandages, blanket, religious clothing.

Silver holy symbol, holy water, prayer beads; rations, sack, tinderbox, 3 torches, wineskin, writing stick; 4 gp.

CLERIC SPELLS - 4 KNOWN

d% (54) - Detect Venom

d% (14) - Ceremony of Consecration

d% (03) - Bless

d% (57) - Light

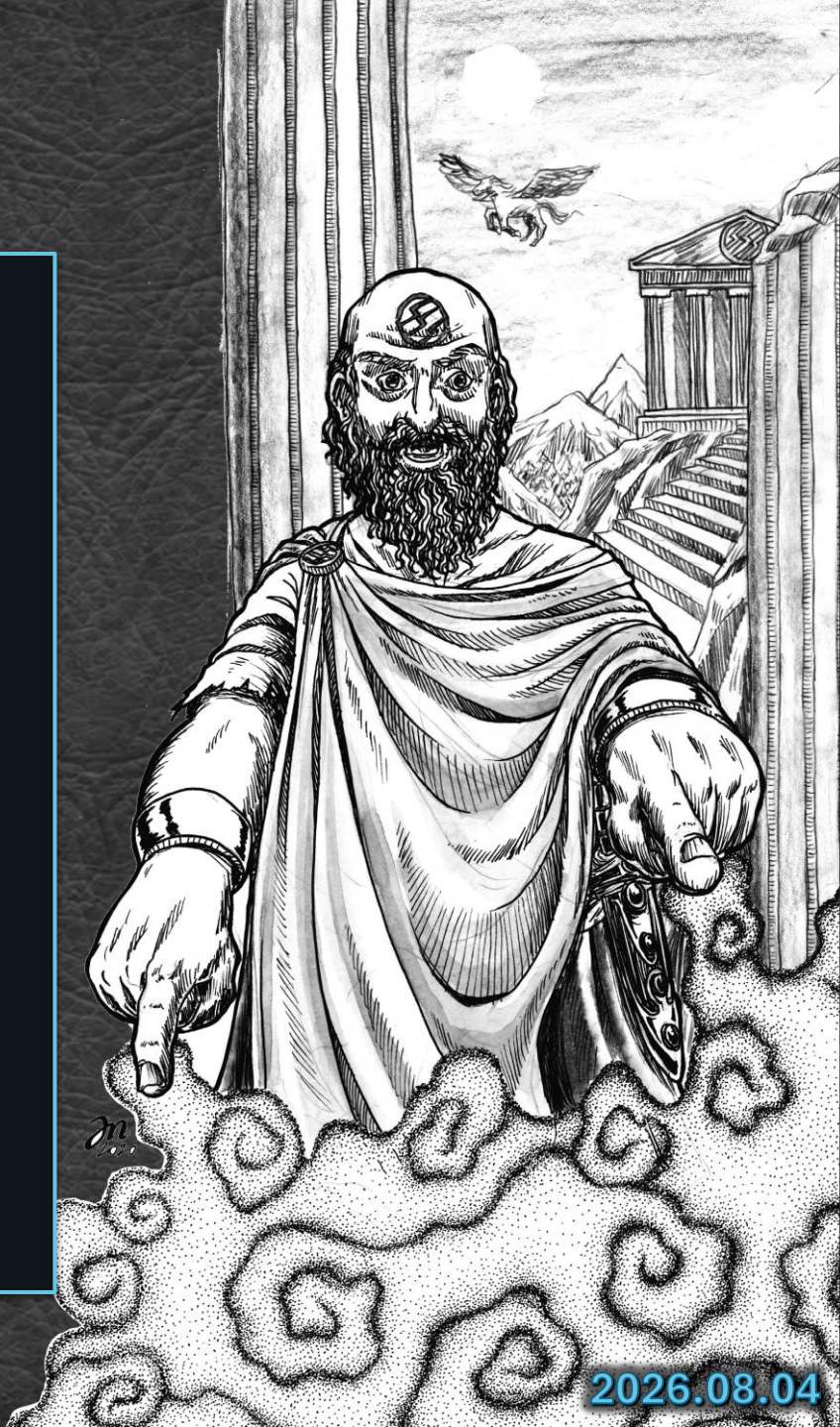
Casts 3 level 1 spells/day: 2 base + 1 WIS.

OTHER STATISTICS

AC 9 - MV 40 - HD 1d4

HP 3: roll 3, CN +0

SV 16 - FA 0 - CA 1 - TA 1



SIGRID - RUNEGRAVER

BACKGROUND

Viking woman, age 19; 5 ft. 11 in., 175 lb.

Blond hair, blue eyes; Chaotic Good.

Common + Old Norse; Ymir and Ullr; brewer/vintner.

RUNEGRAVER STARTING PACK

Studded armour; battle axe, short bow, 12 arrows, 2 silver arrows, dagger.

Quiver, backpack, bandages, chalk, dice, holy symbol, drinking horn, rations, tinderbox, 2 torches, waterskin, writing stick; 4 gp.

STARTING RUNE

d3 (2) Man rune - Command

Invokes 1 level-1 rune/day; costs 1 hp to cast.

OTHER STATISTICS

AC 6: studded armour

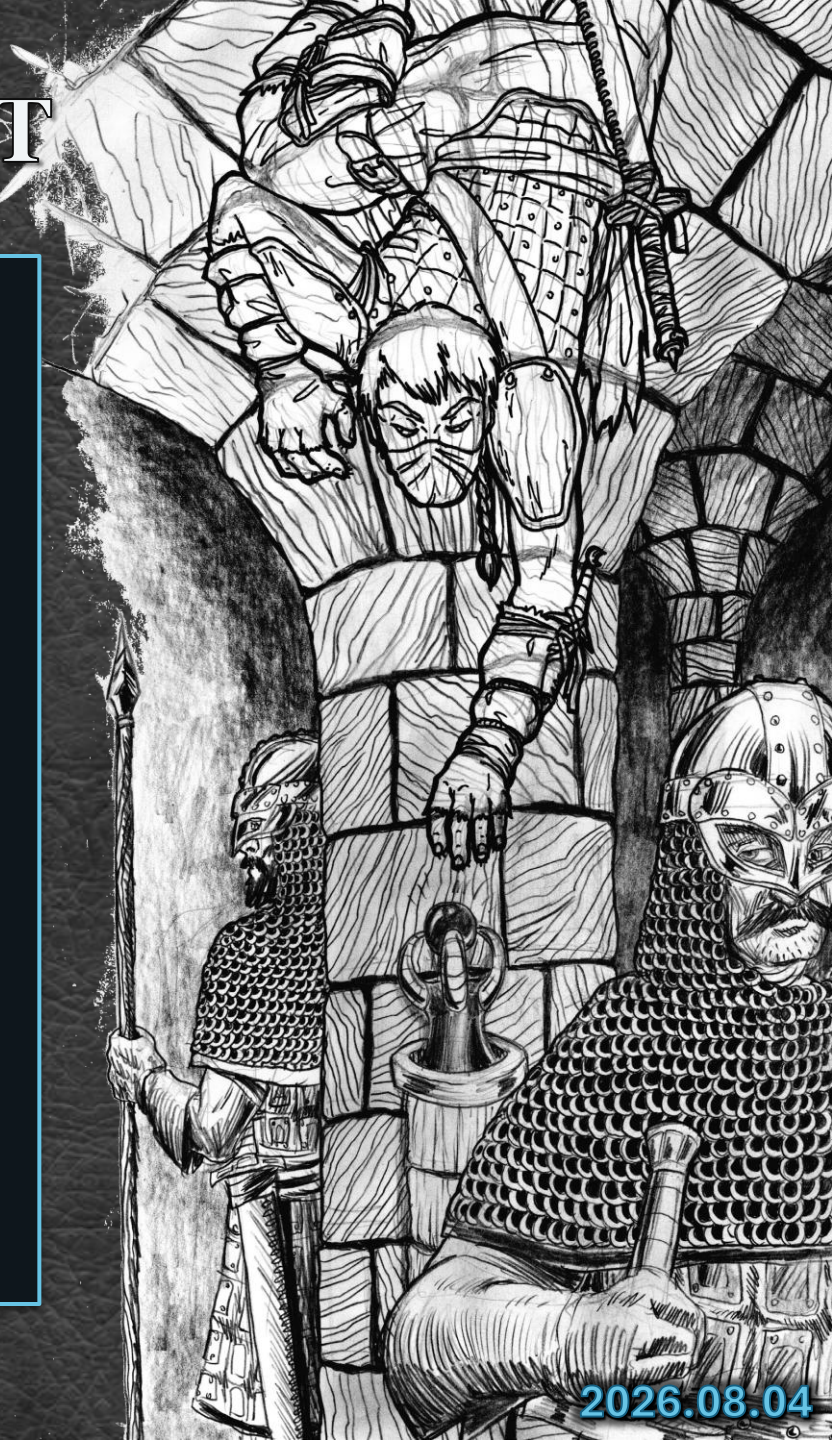
MV 40 - HD 1d8

HP 8: roll 8, CN +/-0

SV 16 - FA 1 - CA 1 - TA n/a



CUNOVINDOS - LEGERDEMAINIST



BACKGROUND

Pict man, age 22; 5 ft. 8 in., 145 lb.

Red hair, green eyes; Neutral.

Common + Keltic (Pictish) + Old Norse; Rel; locksmith.

LEGERDEMAINIST STARTING PACK

Studded armour, small shield; 2 daggers, falcata, sling + 20 bullets.

Backpack, bandages, blanket, writing kit, rations, rope, sack, thieves' tools, tinderbox, 2 torches, wineskin, spell book; 3 gp.

ILLUSIONIST SPELL - 1 KNOWN

d% (27) - Detect Invisibility

Casts 2 level 1 spells/day: 1 base +1 INT.

OTHER STATISTICS

AC 4: studded 6, shield +1, DX +1

MV 40 - HD 1d6

HP 7: roll 6 + 1 CON

SV 16 - FA 1 - CA 1 - TA n/a

KEET YEIL - SHAMAN

BACKGROUND

Tlingit woman, age 31; 5 ft. 3 in., 125 lb.

Black hair, brown eyes; Neutral.

Common + Tlingit + Esquimaux; Raven totem; hunter/trapper.

SHAMAN STARTING PACK

Studded armour; war club, dagger; backpack, bandages, belladonna, censer, totem, 12 incense sticks, mask, rattle.

Rations, rope, sack, tinderbox, 3 torches, wineskin, bark-sheet spell book; 2 gp.

SCHOOLS + STARTING SPELL

Druid + Necromancer selected.

d% 92 Shillelagh - Druid

Casts 2 level 1 spells/day: 1 base +1 WIS.

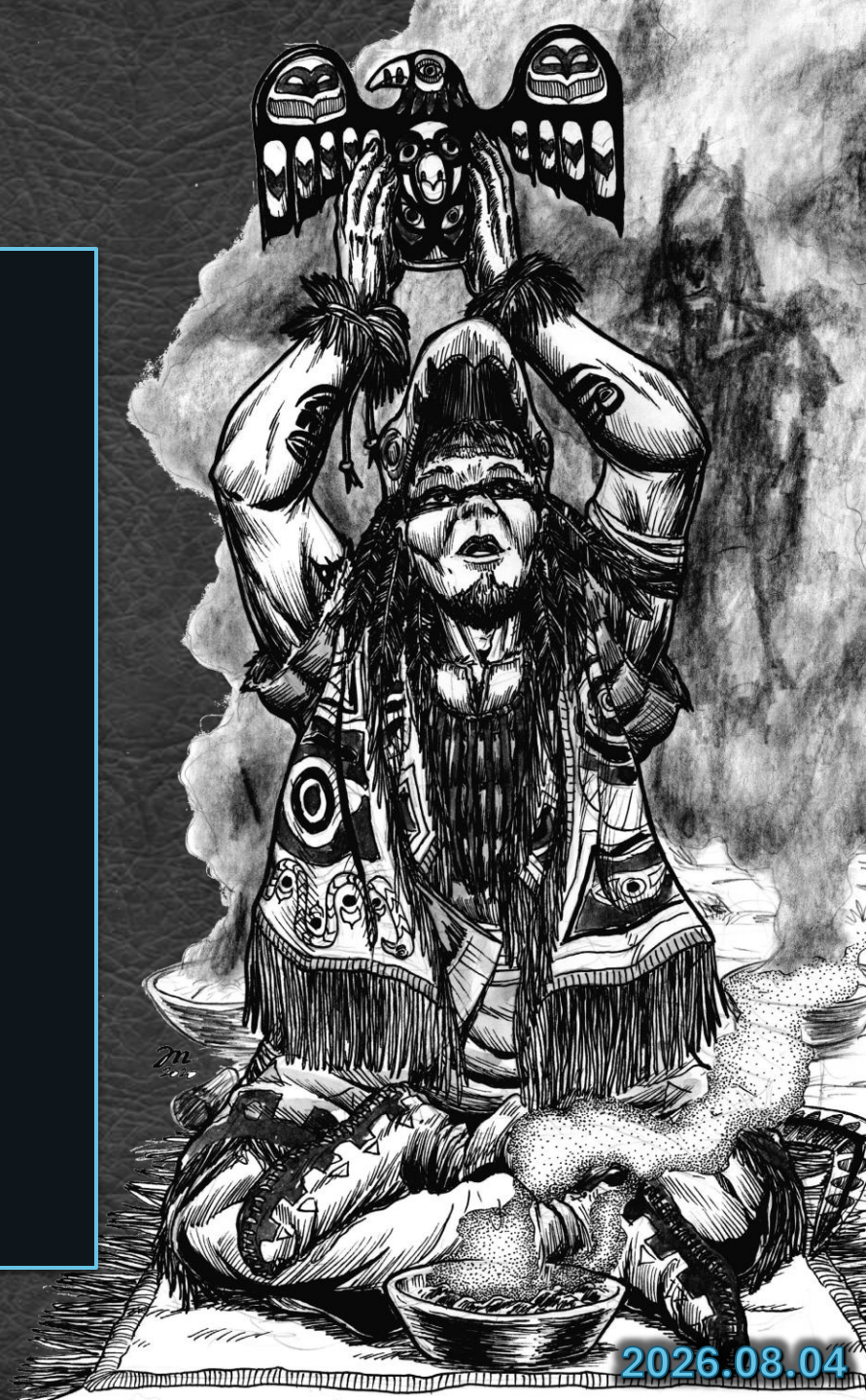
Necromancer spells begin at level 2.

OTHER STATISTICS

AC 6 - MV 40 - HD 1d6

HP 4: roll 3 + 1 CON

SV 16 - FA 0 - CA 1 - TA n/a



XARTHANOS - WARLOCK

BACKGROUND

Ixian man, age 28; 6 ft. 1 in., 205 lb.

Black hair, black eyes; Neutral.

Common + Thracian + Hellenic + Old Norse; Aurorus; soldier/mercenary.

WARLOCK STARTING PACK

Scale mail; battle axe, light crossbow + 20 bolts; backpack, bandages, bolt case, writing kit.

Rations, rope, tinderbox, 2 torches, wineskin, spell book; 4 gp.

MAGICIAN SPELL - 1 KNOWN

Magician school selected; WS 10 rules out ice lord, fire lord, and death soldier.

d% (74) - Shocking Grasp

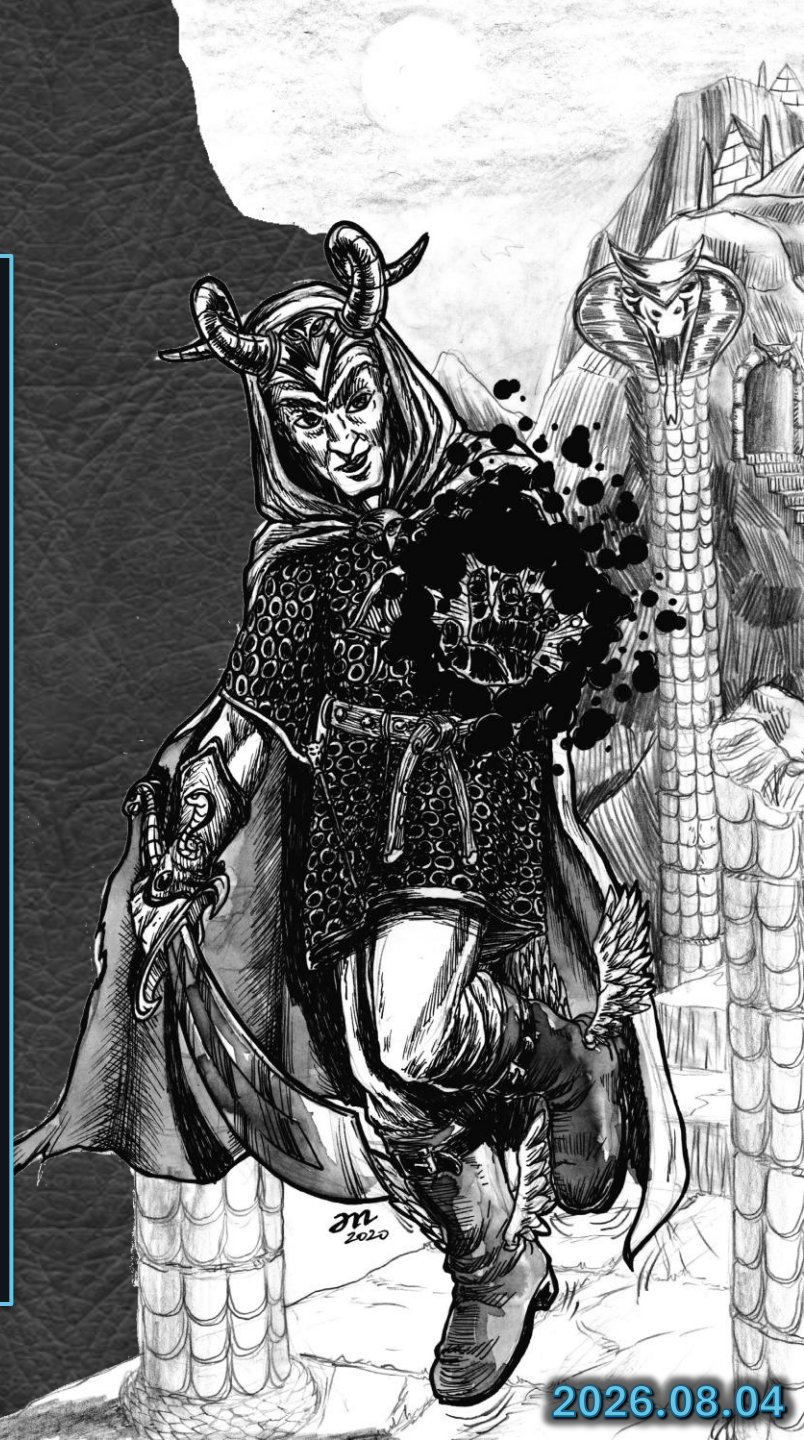
Casts 2 level 1 spells/day: 1 base +1 INT.

OTHER STATISTICS

AC 6 - MV 30 - HD 1d8

HP 9: roll 8 + 1 CON

SV 16 - FA 1 - CA 1 - TA n/a



SIKU - BERSERKER

BACKGROUND

Esquimaux woman, age 20; 5 ft. 7 in., 155 lb.

Black hair, dark eyes; Chaotic Good.

Speaks Common + Esquimaux; illiterate at IN 5.

Ancestral bear spirit; fisherman/whaler.

BERSERKER STARTING PACK

Scale mail; battle axe, 2 hand axes, broad sword; backpack, pouch, rations, sack, tinderbox, 3 torches, wineskin; 2 gp.

STARTING SPELLS

None - Berserker is not a casting class.

OTHER STATISTICS

AC 5: scale 6, DX +1

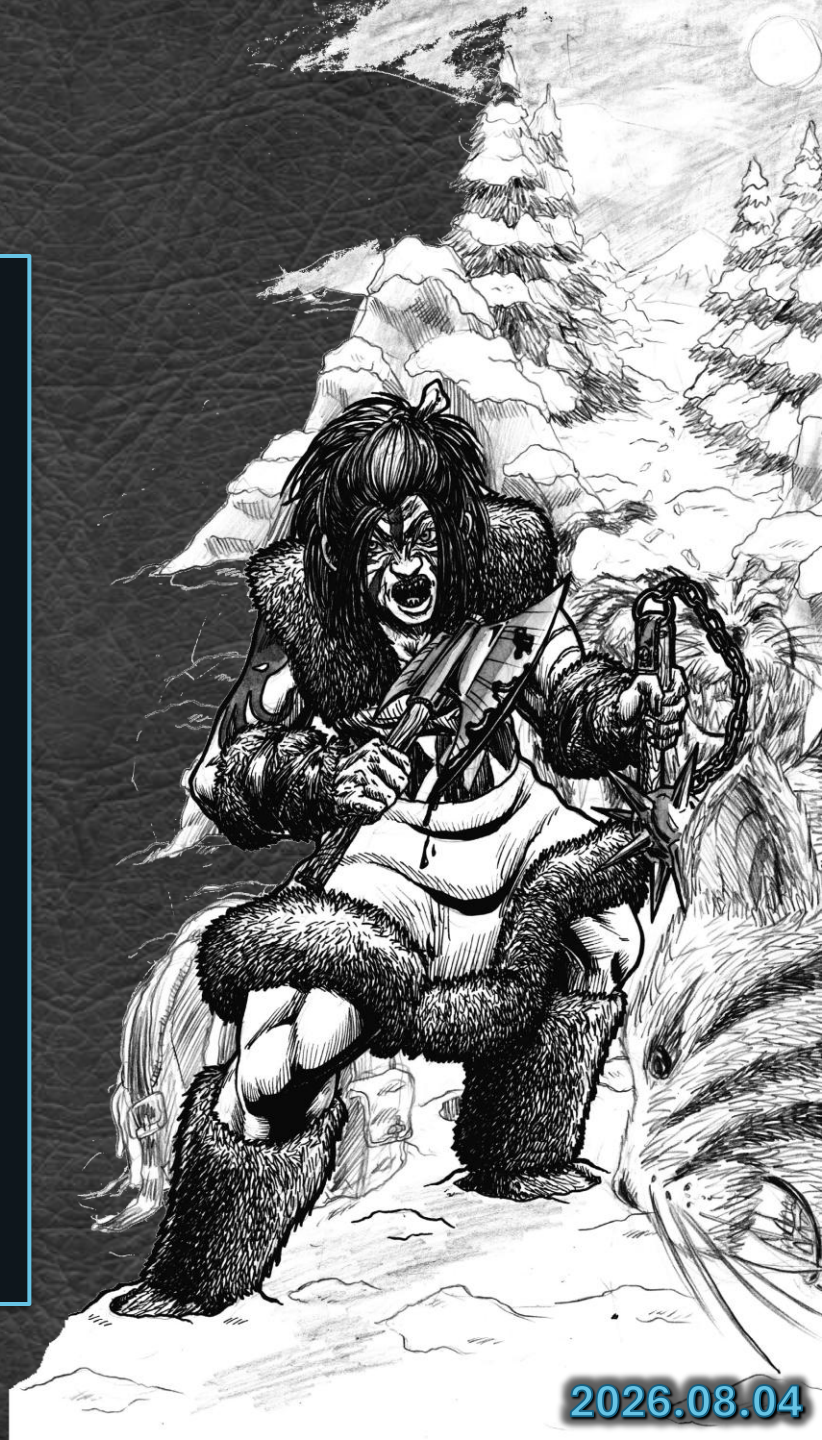
Natural AC 8 when unarmoured.

MV 30 - HD 1d12

HP 10: roll 9 + 1 CON

SV 16, +2 all saves - FA 1

CA n/a - TA n/a



What to Roll / What to Choose?

Races were selected – Each class has a piece of art in the Player's Manual that denotes what race the particular class being represented is; for that reason I selected the race for each class, but it could easily be rolled.

Appendix A (page 286) in the Player's Manual has name generation tables for each race in Hyperborea 3e. Those were randomly rolled.

Background, Height, Weight, and other traits were randomly rolled using the tables in the Player's Manual.

As a referee, the tables are greatly appreciated to help come up with NPC's on the fly – especially the Names appendix!

PDFs for each of the six characters are linked in the description below!

GO PLAY HYPERBOREA!